

FIVE ELECTRONIC GADGETS WORTH WAITING FOR

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The International Consumer Electronics Show (CES) 2018 at Las Vegas saw many new launches in product categories ranging from smartphones to virtual reality (VR) headsets. Here we bring to you select few that are expected to roll out this year

Oculus Go

This name has been doing the rounds for a while. Facebook is keen on delivering a virtual reality experience to the masses. The USP of Oculus Go is that, unlike the existing VR sets in the market, it need not be wired to a smartphone or a laptop to run. The screen to generate VR and processors of the device are in-built.

Go is powered by a strong Snapdragon 821 processor, ensuring a smooth experience to users. The device is said to use a fast-switching 2560 × 1440-pixel LCD technology. Developers claim that this kind of display eliminates lags in image transition, excessive glares and screen door effect (the feeling of viewing the display through a screen door). Go also has an inbuilt audio system for



Oculus Go VR Headset

immersive experience. Alternatively, it comes with a 3.5mm jack, allowing users to connect a pair of headphones.

However, Go is restricted to three degrees of freedom (DOF)—different ways an object can move in a three-dimensional space; an object in a 3D plane has six DOFs.

The material of the headset is designed to avoid any kind of discomfort to users, like sweating, heaviness or congestion. For face padding, it uses a mesh-like (breathable) fabric on a lightweight frame.

Oculus Go may be released early this year at a starting price of \$199. Going by its features, it is an affordable and interesting gadget to look forward to.

Apple Homepod

Amazon and Google are already running strong with their voice-assisted speakers, and Apple is going to join the race too. Apple's Homepod was planned to hit the market by Christmas last year but it got delayed. How-

ever, its official launch got delayed and pre-orders started from January this year.

Homepod is a Wi-Fi-compatible wholesome speaker, standing 17.8cm (7-inch) tall. It houses seven treble speakers, six microphones and a 10cm (4-inch) woofer, surrounded by an



The Apple Homepod (Source: www.pcr-online.biz)